

MacBook M2 to M3 Migration Guide

Overview

This guide helps you migrate from your MacBook Air M2 (500GB) to M3 (256GB) while managing the storage constraints.

Current M2 Usage: 233 GB (after cleanup)

M3 Available: 256 GB

Strategy: Selective migration + fresh dev tool installation

Part 1: Pre-Migration Checklist

Already Completed on M2:

-  Deleted duplicate/unnecessary apps (~30GB saved)
-  Current usage: 233 GB

What Will NOT Transfer (Automatic Savings):

- System Data: ~50 GB (rebuilt fresh on M3)
- macOS: ~31 GB (M3 has its own OS)

Actual transfer size: ~175-180 GB  Fits comfortably!

Part 2: Migration Assistant Strategy

TRANSFER These:

Applications (64.7 GB) - Selectively transfer:

-  Microsoft Office suite (Excel, Word, PowerPoint, Outlook, OneNote, Teams)
-  Google apps (Chrome, Drive, Docs, Sheets, Slides)
-  Final Cut Pro (keep main version only)
-  Apple apps (Pages, Numbers, Keynote)
-  Communication (WhatsApp, Zoom)
-  Visual Studio Code
-  Utilities (Rectangle Pro, FileZilla, VLC, etc.)
-  OneDrive, Firefox, Microsoft Edge

Computer & Network Settings

- Wi-Fi passwords
- System preferences (trackpad, keyboard, display)
- Bluetooth pairings
- VPN configurations
- App preferences

Developer (2.75 GB)

- Will transfer, but you'll reinstall fresh (see Part 3)

Mail (2.29 GB) - Optional

- Transfer if you want email history

SKIP These:

Documents (62.91 GB)

- Contains large video files (VHS project 11GB, test videos 10GB+)
- Manually copy only essential files later
- Most files are in OneDrive/Google Drive/iCloud anyway

Messages (22.61 GB)

- Will re-sync from iCloud automatically

Photos (7.49 GB)

- Will re-sync from iCloud automatically

Part 3: Development Environment Setup

CRITICAL SECURITY WARNING

Your `.zshrc` contains a GitHub token in plain text. **Delete this immediately:**

1. Revoke token at: <https://github.com/settings/tokens>
2. Remove `(GH_TOKEN=)` line from `.zshrc`
3. Use `(gh auth login)` instead (stores tokens securely)

Before Migration - Backup Custom Scripts

On your M2, backup your custom scripts folder:

```
bash
cp -r ~/repos/scripts ~/Desktop/scripts-backup
```

Copy this to external drive or cloud storage.

M3 Setup Script

Save this as `(setup-m3.sh)` on your new M3:

```
bash
```

```
#!/bin/bash
```

```
echo "==== M3 Development Environment Setup ==="
```

```
echo "Starting installation..."
```

```
# 1. Install Homebrew (if not already installed)
```

```
if ! command -v brew &> /dev/null; then
```

```
    echo "Installing Homebrew..."
```

```
    /bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Homebrew/install/HEAD/install.sh)"
```

```
# Add Homebrew to PATH (M3 is Apple Silicon)
```

```
echo 'eval "$(/opt/homebrew/bin/brew shellenv)"' >> ~/.zprofile
```

```
eval "$(/opt/homebrew/bin/brew shellenv)"
```

```
else
```

```
    echo "Homebrew already installed"
```

```
fi
```

```
# 2. Install Homebrew packages
```

```
echo "Installing Homebrew packages..."
```

```
brew install aichat
```

```
brew install azure-cli
```

```
brew install gh
```

```
brew install git
```

```
brew install gnupg
```

```
brew install node
```

```
brew install pandoc
```

```
brew install python@3.13
```

```
brew install telnet
```

```
brew install tesseract
```

```
# 3. Install NPM global packages
```

```
echo "Installing NPM global packages..."
```

```
npm install -g @continuedev/cli
```

```
npm install -g @github/copilot
```

```
npm install -g @githubnext/github-copilot-cli
```

```
npm install -g @google/gemini-cli
```

```
npm install -g azure-functions-core-tools
```

```
# 4. Install Python packages
```

```
echo "Installing Python packages..."
```

```
pip3 install beautifulsoup4
```

```
pip3 install selenium
```

```
pip3 install playwright
```

```
pip3 install requests
```

```
pip3 install pandas
```

```
pip3 install numpy
```

```
pip3 install openpyxl
```

```
pip3 install ollama
```

```
pip3 install PyMuPDF
```

```
pip3 install pytesseract
```

```
pip3 install yt-dlp
```

```
pip3 install html2text
```

```
pip3 install pillow
```

```
# Install Playwright browsers
```

```
echo "Installing Playwright browsers..."
```

```
playwright install
```

```
# 5. Configure Git
echo "Configuring Git..."
git config --global user.name "Dennis H Mathes"
git config --global user.email "dennyrgood@yahoo.com"
git config --global pull.rebase true
git config --global core.excludesfile ~/.gitignore_global

# 6. Authenticate GitHub CLI (interactive)
echo "Authenticating GitHub CLI..."
echo "You'll need to authenticate - DO NOT use token in .zshrc!"
gh auth login

# 7. Setup custom PATH and environment variables
echo "Setting up .zshrc..."
cat >> ~/.zshrc << 'EOF'

# Custom scripts path
export PATH="$HOME/repos/scripts:$PATH"

# Ollama custom host
export OLLAMA_HOST="https://ollama.ldmathes.cc"

# AI Chat timeout
export AICHAT_TIMEOUT=120

# Checkpoint function
checkpoint() {
    sync-this "Checkpoint: $1"
}
EOF

echo ""
echo "=== Setup Complete! ==="
echo ""
echo "⚠️ MANUAL STEPS REQUIRED:"
echo "1. Copy ~/repos/scripts folder from M2 to M3"
echo "2. Create ~/.gitignore_global if you had one"
echo "3. Authenticate GitHub Copilot: Run 'github-copilot-cli auth'"
echo "4. Test: source ~/.zshrc"
echo ""
echo "✅ Your M3 development environment is ready!"
```

Part 4: Step-by-Step Migration Process

Phase 1: Run Migration Assistant

1. On M3 MacBook:

- Open **Migration Assistant** (Applications > Utilities)
- Select "From a Mac, Time Machine backup, or startup disk"
- Click Continue

2. On M2 MacBook:

- Open **Migration Assistant** (Applications > Utilities)
- Select "To another Mac"
- Click Continue

3. Connect & Transfer:

- Enter security code from M2 into M3
- **Select what to transfer:**
 - ☒ Applications (uncheck apps you don't need)
 - ☒ Computer & Network Settings
 - ☒ Developer (optional)
 - ☒ Mail (optional)
 - ☒ Documents (skip - handle manually)
 - ☒ Messages (skip - will sync from iCloud)
 - ☒ Photos (skip - will sync from iCloud)
- Click Continue and wait (may take 1-2 hours)

Phase 2: First Boot on M3

Things that need re-authentication:

- ☐ Touch ID - Set up fresh
- ☐ iCloud - Sign in with Apple ID
- ☐ OneDrive - Sign in
- ☐ Google Drive - Sign in
- ☐ Adobe apps - Sign in and authorize
- ☐ Microsoft Office - May need to reactivate
- ☐ App permissions (Camera, Microphone, Files, etc.)

Phase 3: Development Environment Setup

1. Copy custom scripts:

```
bash

mkdir -p ~/repos
cp -r /path/to/scripts-backup ~/repos/scripts
```

2. Run setup script:

```
bash

chmod +x setup-m3.sh
./setup-m3.sh
```

3. After script completes:

```
bash

# Authenticate GitHub Copilot
github-copilot-cli auth

# Reload shell configuration
source ~/.zshrc
```

4. Verify installation:

```
bash

gh --version
git --version
node --version
python3 --version
pip3 list | grep pandas
npm list -g --depth=0
echo $OLLAMA_HOST
ls ~/repos/scripts
```

Phase 4: Manual File Transfer (If Needed)

For specific documents/files from M2:

1. Enable File Sharing on M2 (System Settings > General > Sharing)
2. Access from M3 via Finder > Network
3. Copy only essential files you need

What Gets Installed - Summary

Homebrew Packages:

- aichat, azure-cli, gh (GitHub CLI), git, gnupg, node, pandoc, python@3.13, telnet, tesseract

NPM Global Packages:

- Continue.dev CLI
- GitHub Copilot
- GitHub Copilot CLI
- Google Gemini CLI
- Azure Functions Core Tools

Python Packages:

- **Web scraping:** beautifulsoup4, selenium, playwright, requests
- **Data analysis:** pandas, numpy, openpyxl
- **AI/ML:** ollama
- **Documents:** PyMuPDF, html2text, pillow
- **OCR:** pytesseract
- **Video:** yt-dlp

Git Configuration:

- User: Dennis H Mathes
- Email: dennyrgood@yahoo.com
- Pull strategy: rebase

Time Estimates

Task	Time
Migration Assistant	1-2 hours
Cloud services re-sync	30-60 min (background)
Dev environment setup	20-25 min
Manual configuration	15-30 min
Total	2-4 hours

Final Verification Checklist

Applications:

- ☐ Microsoft Office opens and works
- ☐ Final Cut Pro launches
- ☐ Visual Studio Code opens
- ☐ Chrome/Firefox work
- ☐ OneDrive syncing

System Settings:

- ☐ Wi-Fi connects automatically
- ☐ Trackpad gestures work as expected
- ☐ Keyboard shortcuts work
- ☐ Touch ID set up

Development Tools:

- ☐ Git works: `git --version`
- ☐ Node works: `node --version`
- ☐ Python works: `python3 --version`
- ☐ GitHub CLI authenticated: `gh auth status`
- ☐ Copilot CLI authenticated
- ☐ Custom scripts accessible
- ☐ Environment variables set: `echo $OLLAMA_HOST`

Cloud Services:

- ☐ iCloud syncing (Photos, Messages)
 - ☐ OneDrive syncing
 - ☐ Google Drive syncing
-

Storage Management on M3

Expected final usage: ~120-140 GB

Free space: ~110-130 GB

Keep M3 Clean:

- Use "Optimize Storage" for iCloud (System Settings > iCloud)
 - Regularly empty Trash
 - Clear browser caches periodically
 - Use cloud storage for large files
 - Avoid local video editing projects (use external drive)
-

Troubleshooting

If apps don't launch:

- Check System Settings > Privacy & Security
- Allow apps to run if blocked
- Some apps may need fresh install

If development tools fail:

- Ensure Homebrew installed correctly: `brew doctor`
- Check PATH: `echo $PATH`
- Reload shell: `source ~/.zshrc`

If storage fills up:

- System Settings > General > Storage
- Click "Review Large Files"
- Check Downloads folder
- Clear browser caches

Support Resources

- **Anthropic/Claude support:** <https://support.claude.com>
- **Migration Assistant:** <https://support.apple.com/en-us/HT204350>
- **Homebrew:** <https://brew.sh>
- **GitHub CLI:** <https://cli.github.com>

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Migration: MacBook Air M2 → MacBook Air M3